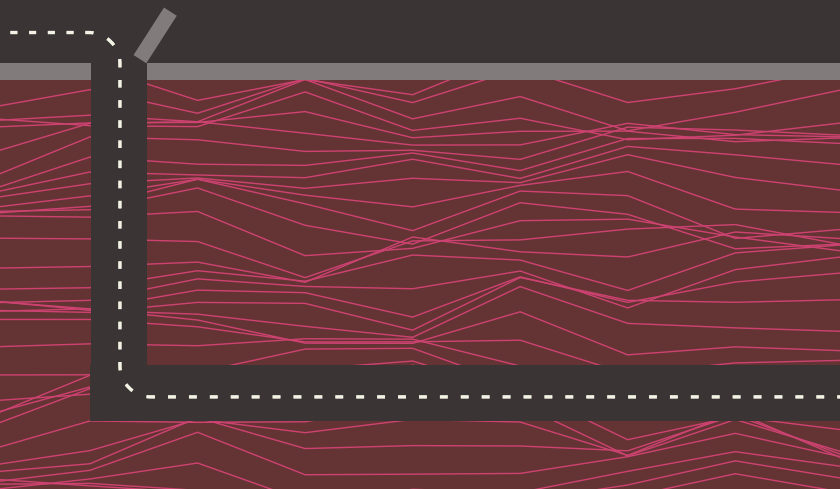




STREET PIT

a play by
Josh Worth



Street Pit

by Josh Worth

BEFORE EVERYTHING

Outside the play. A guy named Shank rides by on an old bike. He looks lost. He stops to talk with Ewe. Ewe could be anybody.

SHANK

Hey. You know where 4-33rd is?

EWE

What?

SHANK

4-33rd.

EWE

I don't think the streets even have numbers. 4-33rd and what?

SHANK

It doesn't matter. It's all one long street.

Shank rides off. Ewe keeps walking.

NEXT

Inside the play now.

A voice from an obscured part of the playing area is chanting numbers. This is Kady.

KADY

Seven seven seven. Four four four. Three three three.
Three three three.

The chanting continues softly beneath the scene.

Ewe enters and spots Shank on the set which suggests the courtyard of an apartment complex. He's talking to a young woman named Candy.

SHANK

Hey. Is this 4-33rd?

CANDY

It is.

SHANK

Do you know Kady?

CANDY

Of course I do. She's my roommate.

SHANK

That is so weird. I've just been randomly searching these streets, like forever.

CANDY

I know, right? That's so amazing.

SHANK

So random.

CANDY

You just came up and asked if I knew Kady, and I was like, "Of course I do. She's my roommate!"

SHANK

You're the first person who said that out of... I don't know how many people.

CANDY

And then I'm thinking like, "Who is this guy? His hair is so cute."

SHANK

Ha. *(Pause)*

I was supposed to come see her.

CANDY

Kady! There's a guy with hair who came to see you.

Ewe stops to watch and sits with the audience.

Beth enters the courtyard.

BETH

What are you even doing, Candy? Don't fall for this shit.

SHANK

Do I know you?

CANDY

That's just Beth. You don't know her.

EWE

(From the audience) That's so weird. I actually do know her.

BETH

He does know me. He just doesn't remember.

SHANK

I'm looking for Kady.

BETH

I bet you are.

Pause.

You know who this is?

CANDY

No.

SHANK

I'm Shank.

BETH

(*Scoffs*) Shank.

CANDY

Have you really looked at him, though? Have you seen his hair?

BETH

This is the guy that opened that hole in the street.

CANDY

Oh... Really? I pictured someone different.

SHANK

What hole?

CANDY

I don't think this is him.

BETH

He doesn't even remember.

Beth leads them out of the courtyard. They stand on the sidewalk, looking out at the street.

A few feet from the sidewalk, a red, rubber object has been plunged into a man-hole-sized opening in the pavement.

Beth stares at Shank, accusingly.

SHANK

I don't think that was me.

CANDY

I'm starting to remember this. Did you and Kady used to play together?

Kady is still off-stage, in the background, whispering the pattern of numbers to herself.

KADY

Seven seven seven. Four four four. Four four four.

SHANK

Maaybe? I don't really remember.

BETH

It wasn't that long ago.

Candy looks at her watch.

CANDY

Oh no. Not again.

BETH

What?

CANDY

It's 4:33. *(Note: This number should correspond to the actual time that the performance is occurring.)*

BETH

So.

SHANK

Like your street?

BETH

No, not like the street.

CANDY

Like the time.

SHANK

I don't think I've ever been here before at this time.

EWE

They could actually chart a graph with the two numbers on each axis to find where they correspond.

BETH

You have and I can prove it.

SHANK

You can?

BETH

Kady! Get out here!

Long pause.

CANDY

Is she awake?

BETH

Kady!

CANDY

We've all been awake this whole time and she's still sleeping like a rock.

SHANK

Or like a baby.

CANDY

Some people say log.

Pause.

Sleeping like a baby on a log.

SHANK

After you hit it on the head with a rock.

BETH

Kady! This is your cue to enter now.

Kady enters looking tired and confused. She's wearing a robe. There's something off about her appearance, like she's wearing a costume of herself.

BETH

Hey.

CANDY

You with us?

BETH

You recognize this guy?

KADY

I'm not sure.

BETH

Come on. I was there.

KADY

What is this? Is this an act or something?

SHANK

This is your proof?

KADY

I'm really sorry. I didn't even know we were doing this so I didn't memorize my lines.

CANDY

Wake up, Kady.

KADY

Nobody gave me a script, so I'm just like... I don't know.

Pause.

KADY

I'm so sorry. Is this me?

BETH

Stop apologizing. It's his fault.

SHANK

What did I do?

KADY

I'm having that thing... that nightmare where you're supposed to go on stage but you're totally unprepared.

CANDY

I've had that.

BETH

We've all had that. Get over it.

SHANK

Are you guys all actors?

CANDY

I've done some acting.

SHANK

Or models maybe? You seem like you could all be stars of stage and screen.

BETH

We're not models. We're actors. Why else would we be here in this crap hole?

SHANK

The same reason everyone is?

BETH

What's that supposed to mean?

CANDY

What are you implying?

SHANK

Nevermind.

CANDY

No it's fine. You can say.

SHANK

Let's just say, I can tell you're not originally from these parts.

EWE

Ouch!

BETH

So?

SHANK

So it might be a crap hole, but for some of us, it's all we've ever had.

CANDY

But your hair is so nice.

SHANK

I had to work for it.

BETH

We work hard.

CANDY

We're following a calling.

BETH

It's a struggle for us too.

SHANK

Just saying, I couldn't just show up one day and be all like, Won't it be neat to live a different life for a little while?

BETH

We didn't choose this life. This life chose us.

CANDY

Exactly.

SHANK

Tell that to daddy and his credit card.

Tense pause.

CANDY

It's true! So we started in the good life. But we reject it. We reject the nice food and the vacations and the people taking care of us.

KADY

We do?

SHANK

Must be nice to have a choice.

BETH

It doesn't matter where we came from or whether we chose this or that. We're stuck here now... Stuck, goddammit!

Pause. Kady is visibly shaken.

KADY

What was that even all about?

SHANK

Lotta wah-wah-wah lookit me lookit me.

CANDY

That's Beth. She speaks the truth.

SHANK

I've been stuck here since the get-go. Never known anything different. You think that makes me special? I'm about as special as every other special piece of special nothing.

KADY

(to Shank) Do you have your lines memorized?

SHANK

I don't have lines. This is me, pure and simple.

KADY

Really? You're being you right now?

SHANK

Who else would I be?

Pause.

BETH

Don't trust him, Kady. He did this last time.

Pause.

SHANK

(To Beth) Did I do something to you? You seem – I don't know.

BETH

I just don't appreciate you coming here and making it so everything from before was like nothing ever happened.

EWE

Ouch!

SHANK

I get that. I can see that. And you're completely right. But actually... I'm having a hard time knowing what you're saying.

CANDY

Me too.

KADY

I know exactly what you mean. I just can't... put it into words.

BETH

Look what you've done to her.

SHANK

Hey. I came looking for her. I've been searching every number of every street out here trying to set things right.

KADY

You didn't have to.

SHANK

It was pure chance that I ended up here.

CANDY

So random.

BETH

Congratulations. You're a hero.

KADY

He reminds me of someone.

Silence.

BETH

So... what? We're going to replay everything as if it hasn't happened a million times before – Just repeating it till we have it memorized and it just comes out automatically?

SHANK

Ok. I hear you. I didn't mean to be that way.

Beth stares at him blankly.

I can see you're hurting and I want you to know I understand, and I'm here to help.

Beth shakes her head slowly.

SHANK

Ok then. "I'm sorry?" Is that what you want to hear?

BETH

I don't want to hear anything. I want to know if you're going to do anything about it.

SHANK

That's what I'm doing. I'm doing that. I'm doing something.

Long silence. Did someone forget their lines?

Ewe shifts awkwardly in their seat. They stand up and sit down a few times.

EWE

(To the actors) It's ok. You got this!

KADY

Is it me?

We hear a very deep rumbling. The characters are frozen in fear. Is there something wrong with the building itself?

KADY

I could say something off the top of my head but I know it won't be right.

BETH

You're fine, Kady.

SHANK

I know you want it to be me, but I'm all out. I really am. I can be the bad guy if you need me too, but I don't know how.

CANDY

He just got lucky and found his way back here.

EWE

Ow!

SHANK

I didn't just get lucky. I worked hard to get back here. I'm very tired.

EWE

(Louder) Owie!

KADY

Are you okay?

BETH

Kady, don't.

EWE

It's okay.

KADY

You seem to be in a lot of pain.

EWE

No. It's... I've got this ingrown toenail. On my big toe...

KADY

Do you need to talk about it?

EWE

It's too painful.

KADY

It's ok.

Ewe stands, partially onstage.

EWE

Something must've fallen on the toe at some point. An object of some sort. Or I stubbed it. I don't know what. But now... now the edge of the toenail is growing in the wrong direction. Rather than grow outwards, it has curled back, and is now growing into the flesh of the toe, so that, as it grows, it causes immense pain and pressure.

KADY

Owie.

EWE

I know. Whenever I take a step with this foot, a searing pain shoots up my entire leg.

KADY

Maybe you should go.

EWE

No I'm fine.

KADY

Then maybe you should stay.

CANDY

Fine with me.

BETH

Who really cares at this point.

SHANK

Seems inappropriate.

BETH

It's not really up to you though, is it? That's kinda the point. This is where we live. And if all of a sudden this rando wanders up in here with an ingrown toenail and we think it's fine, then you better go along with the program.

SHANK

Sure. Fine. Forget I said anything.

CANDY

Beth, Beth, Beth... Always so Beth.

BETH

I'm sorry.

EWE

I can go. It's perfectly fine.

BETH

We can't just do this like this with all the pretending.

SHANK

I disagree.

CANDY

That's why we're here.

BETH

No... Not anymore.

Beth walks over to the red plug in the street.

CANDY

Beth. Come on.

SHANK

There are certain expectations that must be met in order for things to even function properly.

Beth crouches down and begins fiddling with the plug.

KADY

I don't like this.

EWE

That's not a good idea.

CANDY

I should probably go.

EWE

Me too.

Ewe returns to his seat in the audience.

BETH

Uh-uh. I need you with me, Candy.

CANDY

Sure... I can do that... I can.

Beth is struggling to pull out the plug.

Shank approaches her and observes closely.

He looks around the space, rifling through debris until he finds a long, stick-like object. He hands it to Beth.

SHANK

Here.

EWE

Ah, technology.

Beth attempts to pry the plug out of the street using the stick. She struggles for a bit longer.

Finally, the plug pops out.

NEXT

The space is filled with darkness.

A light begins to shine from the hole in the street.

We hear water rushing and gurgling beneath the surface.

Smoke rises from the hole. A delightful aroma permeates the air.

The lights return to normal. The characters are standing exactly where they were when the hole opened.

CANDY

(In disbelief) Why?

Pause.

KADY

That smell.

The others sniff the air.

BETH

Oh my fucking God.

SHANK

What... is that?

The characters move away from the hole, shielding their faces from the odor.

BETH

I promised myself I wouldn't vomit.

KADY

It's so familiar.

CANDY

We need to call someone... or evacuate.

SHANK

Is that sewage?

BETH

Sewage smells better than that.

CANDY

Like sewage after it threw up and died and rotted in a pumpkin for a week.

SHANK

I'm remembering why I put that plug in.

BETH

Yeah... It's starting to come back.

KADY

I'm remembering things too now. I know my lines.

CANDY

About time.

KADY

I let everyone down, didn't I?

BETH

It's fine.

*The characters stand still, watching the glow
emanating from the hole.*

EWE

You know, the smell center and memory centers are all
intertwined in the brain.

CANDY

Shh.

*Kady slowly approaches the hole, holding her
breath.*

SHANK

Stop! What are you doing?

KADY

I need to.

BETH

Let her do it.

Kady gets close to the hole and cautiously peers down inside it.

She nods, knowingly and backs away.

CANDY

So?

Kady nods again.

KADY

It's ok.

SHANK

I cannot believe this.

BETH

Face it. This is better.

SHANK

Do you not smell that?

KADY

It's not that bad.

EWE

Olfactory adaptation. Odor receptors only send signals to the brain when the smell is new.

CANDY

Shh.

EWE

After that, you only perceive the smell if you consciously attempt to.

SHANK

I mean, what? You can't just leave something like that out there.

BETH

Wasn't your call.

SHANK

Sorry. I took action. It's what I do.

CANDY

Action man.

SHANK

I'm sorry, but I make no apologies.

KADY

I forgive you.

BETH

You don't have to, Kady.

KADY

I want to.

BETH

You shouldn't. It'll set a precedent. What then?

CANDY

What then, if a precedent is set?

BETH

We'll have people coming here thinking they can do whatever with the place.

CANDY

Goodbye power of the place.

SHANK

It's not your call.

KADY

It's okay. I need you to do something, though.

SHANK

Of course. Whatever it takes.

Kady takes Shank by the hand and tries to lead him towards the hole. He takes a few steps, then stops.

SHANK

That's ok. I'm fine.

KADY

Not for you. For me.

Shank covers his nose and reluctantly allows Kady to lead him.

SHANK

(Breaking down) I don't really...um...

KADY

We're here together.

The closer Shank gets to the hole, the more upset he becomes.

SHANK

Nuh uh.

They're now close enough to the hole to peer down into it.

KADY

You see.

The subterranean gushing sounds become more pronounced.

SHANK

(An emotional mess) What is that?

KADY

A river of sewage.

SHANK

There's blood though... And parts of things...

KADY

The big river has other tinier rivers flowing inside it.

SHANK

Veins. People's insides... Those things shouldn't be there.

KADY

But they are.

Long pause as Kady and Shank share a moment staring into the hole.

Beth and Candy grow curious and slowly approach the hole, joining Kady and Shank in their moment.

CANDY

I still don't remember it. How you did it.

SHANK

I remember very far back now. I remember that we once remembered into the centuries without books or pictures.

BETH

So you remembered how to cover it up?

SHANK

I just knew. It was passed on to me through my history.

Ewe approaches the hole, paying no mind to the smell.

EWE

It's an ancient technique. A large leaf is placed over the hole and used as a template for carving a mold out of wood...

CANDY

Shh.

Candy ushers Ewe back to his seat.

EWE

The mold is shaped using mud and filled with sap which is left to harden. When it's done, out pops the plug.

SHANK

I just had one with me.

KADY

It was just a plain old street before I cracked it open.

EWE

The size of the initial hole is determined by wrapping a strip of vine or tall grass around the head of the wisest member of the group, then placing the strip on the ground to mark the circumference of the hole.

CANDY

I guess that's actually kind of interesting.

EWE

A stone hammer and chisel made of bone were used to make the first puncture.

KADY

But neither of us paved it over.

SHANK

That was someone else.

CANDY

The work of the great pavers.

BETH

No one cares or understands.

KADY

What's below has always been here. It was always repulsive.

CANDY

We can't just leave it here and ignore it.

BETH

We can cover it up with something better this time. My grandparents have this paste they taught me about.

CANDY

So expensive.

BETH

My parents will pay for it. They owe us that.

Kady shakes her head.

SHANK

Must be nice.

BETH

Just let me reach out.

KADY

No.

BETH

Since when did you get all he answers?

KADY

We just have to live with it.

BETH

We'll choke on the smell!

KADY

You're just as bad as him.

BETH

I'm not sure I can even be a part of this any more.

SHANK

I was not aware that was an option.

EWE

She can sit with me.

KADY

That's fine. Whatever.

Beth starts walking towards Ewe.

Kady removes her shoes.

CANDY

What are you doing?

SHANK

I don't know about that.

Kady sits down and lowers her feet into the hole.

BETH

I'm sorry, but that is disgusting.

EWE

I couldn't do that due to my toe, which everyone seems to have forgotten about.

Kady lowers herself even further, then drops down with a splash.

CANDY

That is wrong.

SHANK

Are you ok?

KADY

It's horrible... But it's actually not that bad.

We hear Kady splashing around.

BETH

Don't expect anyone to go near you again.

Shank takes off his shoes.

EWE

An ingrown toenail is already a microbial inflammation, even without touching all of whatever that is.

BETH

You're making a lot of sense.

EWE

Thank you.

Shank lowers himself into the hole.

SHANK

(Shocked and disgusted) Oh no no no no... Oh no.

CANDY

Is it cold?

SHANK

It's warm. Why is it warm like this?

KADY

You get used to it.

BETH

You can get used to anything. Doesn't make it right.

Shank and Kady splash below the surface. They whisper inaudibly, then begin giggling playfully.

CANDY

What is it? What's so funny?

More giggling from below.

Come on. What is it?

KADY

You can come see.

CANDY

No thanks.

SHANK

It's actually fine. It's safe.

Pause.

Candy sits down and takes off her shoes.

BETH

Candy. Don't.

CANDY

Aren't you curious?

BETH

No. Not at all.

CANDY

It might be important.

*Shank and Kady have moved away from the hole.
Their voices can be heard echoing below.*

SHANK

Do you see that tunnel over there? It's a tributary into a massive network that was once used by my people as a means of transport.

KADY

Our people.

SHANK

Sorry.

BETH

Disgusting.

KADY

We can go anywhere.

CANDY

It sounds interesting.

Candy drops down into the hole with a splash.

She gags uncontrollably.

BETH

That was not a good idea.

CANDY

I'm okay...

BETH

This is not for you.

CANDY

It's fine. It's for all of us.

BETH

I don't want to.

CANDY

You'll be left behind.

Beth is disturbed and upset.

She sits down and begins to take off her shoes.

The lights go down as she scoots into the pit and disappears.

MUCH LATER

The hole remains open as the lights rise again.

The characters are back in the courtyard. They look fresh and different.

Candy, Shank and Beth are watching an old TV set.

On the screen, children are unwrapping presents.

NARRATOR

(Voiced by Ewe) In this reenactment of a ritual which began in the twelfth century, each child receives a gift from an older child.

This child has received a precious mineral.

This child receives a piece of candied fruit.

SHANK

The little people are so happy.

BETH

They're called children.

SHANK

Not really. This is a reenactment.

CANDY

They're just tiny people who were small enough to fit inside the screen.

Kady enters carrying her shoes and a pizza delivery bag.

BETH

Is there a pizza in there?

KADY

I wish. I can bring one home tonight.

NARRATOR

The eldest child, closest to the age of fourteen, receives no gift, and is expected to marry by the subsequent season.

BETH

You get back so late. We need one now.

KADY

You'll have to wait.

BETH

Make sure it's divided into eight equal slices so that we each get two.

KADY

That's the only way we've always done it.

NARRATOR

If a marriage does not take place, the parents are permitted to drown the child in a nearby lake.

Kady puts the straps of the pizza bag over her shoulders and wears it like a backpack.

She picks up her shoes.

CANDY

Be gracious out there.

KADY

Is there any other way?

*Kady exits the courtyard and walks to the hole.
She drops down into the hole with a splash.*

The others sit in silence, watching the screen.

One of the children unwraps a doll made of straw.

NARRATOR

The gifts, often handmade by the children themselves, were usually of little interest to the recipients and were soon disposed of in drawers or closets where they accumulated over time.

Some of these gifts have survived the centuries yet still go unappreciated.

CANDY

That voice sounds like the person who used to come up here to say random things.

BETH

It is.

CANDY

Get up here, Ewe.

Ewe limps on stage.

BETH

I knew it was him.

CANDY

How is the toe?

EWE

They were able to save it.

SHANK

Save it? Was it really that bad?

EWE

It hurt a lot and nobody cared until I told people about it up here.

SHANK

Seemed like you were just whining.

EWE

The attention made a difference.

SHANK

You'd be surprised how often it doesn't.

EWE

They gave me an ointment.

BETH

That's great.

EWE

I need to pay for it, so that's why I'm doing the voice thing.

BETH

Terrific.

EWE

It's not my first choice.

CANDY

You're a hard worker.

BETH

Is he though?

SHANK

It's not like he's down there like Kady.

EWE

No. I'm not cut out for that.

SHANK

Nobody is.

CANDY

At least she's got something.

(To Ewe) You too, buddy.

EWE

(In the narrator voice) Some of the handmade gifts have survived the centuries and can still be found to this day.

Ewe opens a drawer on the cabinet underneath the TV.

CANDY

(Impressed / Curious) No kidding.

Candy reaches in the drawer, feels around, then pulls out a straw doll, identical to the one the child had opened on screen.

She holds the doll like a puppet, and bounces it around in front of her, giving it life.

SHANK

It's one of the little people from the screen.

Ewe leads Shank to another drawer (or similar hiding place.)

Shank feels around and pulls out a small carving made from a fruit pit.

Candy comes over to take a look. The straw doll-puppet is also curious.

SHANK

Someone carved a scene into a peach pit... It's so intricate. It's a festival of some sort. There's a booth selling sausages... Wagon rides... a costume contest. A woman with a trained rat.

While Shank is enraptured by the sculpture, Ewe leads Beth to another hiding spot on the set.

She finds a necklace made from natural materials.

BETH

I have no need for any of these things.

The straw doll appears to whisper something in Candy's ear.

CANDY

Some kid made that a long time ago. You should at least try it on.

Beth reluctantly places the necklace around her neck.

BETH

So unnecessary.

Candy holds the doll to her ear and listens. She appears to be repeating what it tells her.

CANDY

It will bring you good fortune...

(Whisper whisper) Or it will curse you.

BETH

Great. Which is it?

CANDY

(Whisper whisper) It's up to you.

EWE

I'm afraid you're getting false information. The doll doesn't know these things.

BETH

Who are you to say?

EWE

I've been granted a certain level of expertise in my position.

CANDY

This little guy knows a lot more than he's saying.

EWE

Is that so?

CANDY

(Whisper whisper) He says Ewe should have the necklace.

BETH

Fine by me.

EWE

I don't want it.

Beth places the necklace around Ewe's neck.

BETH

It brings either good fortune, or bad luck. You get to decide.

EWE

I choose good fortune.

CANDY

(Whisper whisper) Sorry. I had it wrong. You actually get the opposite of what you choose.

EWE

I choose bad luck.

CANDY

Too late.

SHANK

(Still staring at the fruit pit carving) It's funny — a fortune-teller has set up a tent where you can spin the wheel of fortune.

EWE

Please. That's not in the script at all.

SHANK

See for yourself.

He hands Ewe the fruit pit. Ewe stares into it.

EWE

It is quite detailed.

SHANK

Look behind the booth where the farmer is selling the oversized corn.

EWE

Ah yes. A soothsayer says I can spin the wheel for a ha'penny.

SHANK

Go ahead. Give it a spin.

EWE

I don't have a ha'penny.

SHANK

Nobody does. Just pretend.

*Ewe pretends to hand a ha'penny to someone
inside the fruit pit.*

EWE

It's just pretend, right?

BETH

Up to you.

EWE

But it's not actually deciding my fate, obviously.

BETH

Up to you.

Ewe looks into the fruit pit.

EWE

It's stopping.

Shank grabs the fruit pit from Ewe.

BETH

Where it stops, nobody knows.

They wait for the wheel to stop.

SHANK

It says you're doomed.

EWE

It does not. Let me see that.

Ewe grabs the pit.

I don't see anything. It's gone.

He tosses the pit on the ground.

The others stare at him accusingly.

Candy picks up the pit.

CANDY

Nope. Still there. Sure enough. It says you're doomed.

EWE

You're making that up.

BETH

You could've said whatever you wanted.

CANDY

(Listening to the doll) Nothing but bad luck from here on out.

EWE

Is that so? Is that what your little friend tells you?

CANDY

You might as well go back to your seat.

EWE

Fine. I don't need to participate in this... Whatever this is. It's stupid is what it is.

Ewe turns and begins to walk offstage.

Candy holds the straw doll over her head.

CANDY

(Loudly – In the voice of the doll) You will never be part of anything ever again.

Ewe stops, turns around and storms towards Candy. She tries to run from him, but he catches her and rips the straw doll from her hands.

In a fit, he throws the doll to the ground and stomps on it while the others look on in horror.

Ewe stops to rest and looks shamefully at the remains of the doll.

CANDY

You killed it.

EWE

Please. It's not even a real thing.

CANDY

You said it was passed down.

EWE

You were just manipulating it.

CANDY

You said it with such authority.

EWE

I was repeating predetermined words.

CANDY

But you said them.

EWE

(Nervously) It was a reenactment...

BETH

You've really upset her.

EWE

That's what we're doing here... right? Reenacting?

SHANK

Candy's trying to play along and then you come in here and tell her she's not playing along right.

BETH

Who gave you the right?

EWE

I showed you where to find these things.

SHANK

You were reenacting things that happened before.

EWE

Didn't we all agree to follow this course of events? I mean... You're just kidding, right?

BETH

Are you in or are you out? Can't have it both ways.

EWE

I'm in. I've been in the whole time and it upsets me that you think I haven't been.

SHANK

Then get in. No more teetering in between.

BETH

He needs a costume.

CANDY

That's the problem.

EWE

(Touching the necklace) I'm wearing this.

CANDY

We don't control that.

BETH

Get some of Kady's old stuff.

Candy goes to an obscured area of the stage and returns with a pile of clothes.

CANDY

It's all dirty.

EWE

That's fine.

CANDY

It smells like pizza.

BETH

Let me smell.

She takes a whiff and recoils in disgust.

BETH

It smells like the street pit.

EWE

I really don't understand why this is necessary.

BETH

Are you in this, or are you not?

EWE

It just seems like we could be doing something altogether different.

BETH

Then go do it. We don't need you!

EWE

You have no idea what you're talking about.

SHANK

We could use him, but we don't need him.

Candy puts a robe around Ewe. It's the same robe Kady was wearing at the beginning.

CANDY

See. It's nice.

EWE

It is nice. Thank you.

CANDY

Let's get you in your place.

Candy puts her arm around Ewe and begins leading him toward the obscured area.

Ewe stops abruptly and moves away from Candy.

EWE

See, no. This is the part I'm not interested in.

BETH

Uh-uh. You can't just pick and choose parts of the part. You play the part or you don't play the part.

Shank steps in to help Candy move Ewe into position.

EWE

Nobody has thought this through.

SHANK

That's the deal.

EWE

Doesn't that worry you?

SHANK

We're always worried.

BETH

We have an open position and you are in it.

SHANK

Simple as that.

BETH

So get back there and do what is required of you.

Ewe is paralyzed.

Beth swats him in the head.

EWE

Stop!

SHANK

Move.

EWE

I don't know what I'm doing.

SHANK

Welcome to the club.

EWE

There's that hole out there. I can't deal with it.

CANDY

Seriously?

EWE

The smell? All the stuff flowing underneath us?

BETH

Fine. Plug it up.

SHANK

Seriously?

Shank walks out to the street. He rifles through a pile of debris and finds the red plug from before.

CANDY

What about Kady?

BETH

She's moved on.

SHANK

We'll see her again.

CANDY

It's fine.

SHANK

You sure this is okay?

BETH

How would I know?

CANDY

It's fine.

Shank puts the red plug back in the hole.

BETH

Better?

EWE

I still know it's there.

CANDY

It's fine.

BETH

You'll forget about it.

EWE

What am I supposed to do?

BETH

You'll figure it out.

SHANK

Or maybe not.

Candy ushers Ewe into position in the obscured area.

CANDY

Do you want the slippers?

EWE

Would that help?

CANDY

Probably. Try the slippers.

Ewe sits down to take off his shoes.

SHANK

I guess I'm out of here.

BETH

It's been real.

SHANK

Has it?

Shank exits.

EWE

I don't think I can do this.

CANDY

You can do it.

EWE

I also don't think it's fair that I'm asked to do this.

CANDY

What else are you going to do?

EWE

There's got to be something?

CANDY

Look around. It's the only show in town.

Ewe reluctantly puts on the slippers.

EWE

I'm not okay. How are any of you okay with any of this?

CANDY

You forget about the hard parts.

SHANK

You adapt. It's important to adapt.

Ewe starts to break down. Candy, Shank, and Beth look at each other, uncomfortably.

BETH

I'm out. You got this?

CANDY

I guess.

Candy sits down and helps Ewe put on the slippers.

EWE

I just want it to be over.

CANDY

I know a technique. Tell me your phone number.

EWE

433-5252

CANDY

That's a nice number. Can you say it backwards?

EWE

Two..five... Two Five. Three three... four.

CANDY

Now say it backwards again but say each number three times.

EWE

Two two two... five five five... Two two two. Five five five... three three three. Three three three... Four four four.

CANDY

So just keep doing that 'til we're ready for you.

EWE

How will I know you're ready?

CANDY

There will be a dead silence that needs to be filled.

SHANK

I'm out too.

As Shank exits into the audience, Kady enters and the two share a moment in passing.

EWE

(Softly) 2 2 2. 5 5 5. 2 2 2. 5 5 5. 3 3 3. 3 3 3.

Shank re-enters.

SHANK

Hey. Is this five thirty-third?

CANDY

It is.

Kady takes a place in the audience.

SHANK

Do you know Kady?

CANDY

Of course I do. She's my roommate.

SHANK

That is so weird. I've just been randomly searching these streets, like forever.

CANDY

I know, right? That's so amazing.

SHANK

So random.

The lights go down. The gushing noises beneath the street continue into the darkness.